

Chapter 103-1

Her gentle voice was as if dipped in honey. When singing a cappella, it sounded like someone who had just woken up—tender and delicate.

"See the moon like the pupil of the night sky

Quietly gazing at you and me and our clamoring planet."

Xu Qingzhu had also heard this song before. Liang Shi was considerate to the extreme.

When she made a request, Liang Shi would comply without even asking why or bargaining with her.

At this moment, Xu Qingzhu had no doubt that if she asked for something else, Liang Shi would also do it without hesitation.

No matter what she asked for.

Liang Shi trusted her completely.

It was only later when Xu Qingzhu looked it up that she learned what kissing someone's instep meant.

The internet said—kissing the instep meant submission.

That day it had been something she did while drunk. Although it couldn't be taken seriously, it made the one who tended to overthink toss and turn sleeplessly for several nights.

Even if on the surface she appeared calm and indifferent to favor or disgrace, in her heart there were surging waves that could rise at any moment. Even after several days had passed, just thinking about it would still make her ears turn slightly red.

After all, it was an experience that made one's tailbone tingle. The sensation was too vivid, making it too unforgettable.

Perhaps darkness made people bolder, allowing them not to be bound by rules.

Xu Qingzhu gently bit Liang Shi's neck, biting right where she made sound, causing Liang Shi's singing voice to break off.

When you like someone, you always unconsciously want to get closer and press against them.

The slower this process, the more captivating it becomes.

This was probably the psychology of delayed gratification—the slower you obtain what you want most, the more you'll cherish it and find it unforgettable and precious.

If something is too easily obtained, it always feels too cheap and too easy.

With someone you like, you don't need to be pressed close together for long. A hug, or a brief touch of fingers, can feel like electricity.

Xu Qingzhu's slender pale fingers undid the last button of Liang Shi's nightgown, and it fell completely loose.

The melody Liang Shi sang a cappella was easy to follow, but her voice was also restrained.

Xu Qingzhu released her and unconsciously hummed along with the melody.

"Getting close to you, why are we both suddenly at a loss for words

Making heartbeats surge like wildfire spreading across the plains."

Her voice was cool, yet at this moment it was tinged with the same tenderness as Liang Shi's.

Liang Shi smiled helplessly, not quite understanding this preference of hers, yet her voice made her heart itch, like a feather gently tickling the tip of her heart.

This wasn't a continuous feeling—it was like an ancient torture method, scratching at the places you're most afraid of being tickled, trapping you there unable to move, yet powerless to do anything.

The difference between the two was that torture made people afraid, unwilling for it to happen again.

But this kind of feeling was like waves that could crash in from the sea at any moment, making your heart itch yet constantly anticipating them.

The red spreading from the corners of Liang Shi's eyes was so beautiful it seemed unreal, like the crimson clouds at dusk.

Not falling on the horizon or into the sunset, but falling into her light brown eyes.

Those eyes were as bright as ever, yet more captivating than usual.

Liang Shi lay on her side, close to Xu Qingzhu, her voice low and husky, overlapping with Xu Qingzhu's voice in the air.

The cool voice and the gentle voice blended together without any discord.

The two different voices merged perfectly, sounding like a clear stream flowing peacefully through a valley, passing mountains and rivers, merging into the sea.

A gentle stream made one feel peaceful, tender, and comfortable.

The lyrics were also fitting for the moment. Both of them wore smiles, and even Xu Qingzhu's usually cool eyes were now tinged with warmth.

Liang Shi tried hard to match Xu Qingzhu's singing rhythm, finally falling in step with her.

"In this moment, let even fate fall silent

Let our toes glide across sky and sky, earth and earth

The universe of destiny."

Xu Qingzhu suddenly let out a soft laugh, burying her head in the crook of Liang Shi's shoulder. The hair at her temples was already a bit damp, yet she laughed foolishly, laughing until her whole body shook, which made Liang Shi's voice tremble too.

Liang Shi was helpless. She stopped but didn't dare speak.

Liang Shi's fingers were beautiful, and she didn't like to keep long nails. Her hands were slender and long, without even calluses on her fingernails.

Xu Qingzhu had compared them before while holding her hand. She didn't know if Alpha hands naturally had an advantage over Omega hands, or if it was because Liang Shi was tall, but her hands were a size larger than Xu Qingzhu's, and even her fingers were a segment longer—about the length of a fingernail.

But they were both women, and Xu Qingzhu was only a few centimeters shorter than her, so that fingernail-length difference seemed like a lot.

They had never interlocked fingers before.

Though Liang Shi had held Xu Qingzhu's hand, palm to palm overlapping, walking together for long distances.

They had also strolled by the seaside, hands tightly clasped while watching the ocean.

But Liang Shi wasn't someone who dared to hold hands easily. Every time she first held someone's hand, her grip was very loose, even hovering in the air. Xu Qingzhu always had to move closer before she could hold on tightly.

It was as if she had to muster great courage.

Xu Qingzhu's thoughts gradually drifted. Suddenly, there was a loud clap of thunder outside, pulling her scattered thoughts back together.

Her hand suddenly fell on Liang Shi's free hand, interlocking their fingers.

Xu Qingzhu nestled in Liang Shi's embrace.

Liang Shi's voice was infinitely amplified by her ear, slowing down as she sang the last line, "Seven, eight, nine—we elope to the moon."¹

So gentle that it made you willing to accompany her to the end of the universe.

And without any hesitation.

1. This is the final line from the song "私奔到月球" (Elope to the Moon) by Mayday featuring Cheer Chen. The "seven, eight, nine" (七八九) is a countdown in the song leading to the romantic declaration of eloping to the moon together. The song is about two people wanting to escape the world together and find their own private paradise on the moon.